

RACHEL CLIFFORD

COMPUTER SCIENCE STUDENT

CONTACT

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EDUCATION

HIGH SCHOOL
St Mary's DSG, Kloof
2019-2023
7 Distinctions

COMPUTER SCIENCE
UNIVERSITY OF PRETORIA
2024 - current

SKILLS

- Software Engineering
- Database Design
- Data Processing
- Website Design
- Artificial Intelligence
- Java
- Python
- SQL
- React
- Team Collaboration
- Public Speaking

ABOUT ME

I am a third-year Computer Science student at the University of Pretoria, with a strong interest in website and UI/UX design. I am driven by finding creative ways to solve real-world problems and bridge gaps in the market through software engineering.
In my final-year capstone project, SpendSense, a gamified financial tracking platform, I spearheaded the design and UI/UX, shaping how users interact with and experience the product. This work strengthened my ability to turn ideas into intuitive, user-centred software while collaborating closely within a development team.
I enjoy problem solving and troubleshooting, and I approach challenges with curiosity and persistence. Alongside my technical skills, I bring five years of high school debating experience, for which I was awarded full colours. Debating made me a confident public speaker and a clear, persuasive communicator, skills I apply when presenting ideas and working with others.
I plan to further my studies with a BSc Honours in Computer Science in 2027.

EXPERIENCE

Frontend Developer & UI/UX Design Lead – SpendSense
(COS301 Capstone Project, Team MARK2)
University of Pretoria, in partnership with EPI-USE Labs and Advance | March 2026 – October 2026

SpendSense is a gamified financial tracking platform that encourages better money habits through rewards, streaks and progress tracking.

- Spearheaded the design and UI/UX of the platform, defining the visual identity, user flows and overall user experience.
- Created a brand guide to keep design, colour and typography consistent across the team, including the platform's mascot, Mark.
- Developed the frontend using React, TypeScript and Vite.
- Built a library of reusable UI components for the gamification features, including stickers and toast notifications, progress bars, gauges, a streak tracker, an XP indicator and a credit score gauge.
- Developed core application screens, including the user dashboard and the financial obligations form.

Skills used: React, TypeScript, Vite, HTML/CSS, Git, UI/UX design, prompt engineering, team collaboration